MODULE 24 · SECTION 4 - BUSINESS STRATEGIES FOR A SUCCESSFUL GEN AI SOLUTION

Choosing gen AI use cases that pay off

Start from the business problem, weigh value against feasibility, pick the right type of solution, and prove the impact.

SECTION 4 of 4 EXAM WEIGHT ~15% MODULE 24 of 33

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Start with the problem, not the technology.
"We need AI" is not a use case.

From a vague wish to a real use case

VAGUE WISH	REAL USE CASE
"Use AI in the contact centre"	Cut repeat contacts about order status by half
"Use AI for marketing"	Halve the time to write each product description
"Use AI in finance"	Stop 14 people retyping 52,000 invoices a month
"Use AI for staff"	Answer policy questions on the shop floor in seconds

THE TIEBREAKER

A good use case names the problem, who has it, and a measurable outcome. If you cannot measure it, you cannot prove it.

Value against feasibility

QUADRANT	WHAT TO DO
High value, high feasibility	Quick wins: start here
High value, low feasibility	Big bets: plan carefully, fix blockers first
Low value, high feasibility	Nice to have: only if cheap
Low value, low feasibility	Drop it

REMEMBER

Feasibility asks about data, skills, risk and integration. Value asks about money, time, customers and staff.

Business requirements or technical constraints?

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS

What the business needs

- The outcome and the KPI
- Who uses it, and where
- Budget and deadline
- Rules it must follow

TECHNICAL CONSTRAINTS

What the technology allows

- Data quality and access
- Latency and scale
- Integration with systems
- Security and residency

THE TIEBREAKER

Requirements define success; constraints limit the options. A good choice satisfies both, and requirements come first.

Solution types: use, configure, or build

SOLUTION TYPE	GOOGLE EXAMPLES
Use it as it is	Gemini app, Gemini in Workspace
Configure it	Gemini Enterprise, Workflow Builder, Agent Search
Build on a platform	Agent Platform, Agent Studio, ADK
Build your own model	Rarely worth it; last resort

THE TIEBREAKER

Choose the lowest rung that meets the requirements. Faster value, lower cost, less risk.

Automate the routine, augment the expert

AUTOMATE

AI does the task

- Repetitive, high volume
- Clear rules for right and wrong
- Low risk per item
- Invoices, routing, tagging

AUGMENT

AI helps a person do it better

- Judgement or creativity needed
- High stakes or nuance
- People stay accountable
- Campaigns, credit, hiring

THE TIEBREAKER

Repetitive and rule-bound: automate. Creative, strategic or high-stakes: augment, with a person in charge.

A pilot that proves something

01
Baseline
Measure today's KPI before you start.

02
Scope
One team, one process, a few weeks.

03
Build
Use the lowest rung that works.

04
Measure
Same KPI, same way, after.

05
Decide
Scale, adjust or stop.

THE TAKEAWAY

A pilot without a baseline proves nothing. A pilot without a decision date never ends.

Return on investment, in plain terms

SIDE OF THE SUM	WHAT TO COUNT
Benefits	Hours saved, revenue gained, errors and costs avoided
Costs	Licences, tokens, build, change management, upkeep
Soft benefits	Satisfaction, staff morale, faster decisions
Time	When benefits start, and how long they last

REMEMBER

Count all the costs, including people and change, not just the licence. Compare against the baseline, not against zero.

Wrenfield's ideas, prioritised

IDEA	VERDICT
Invoices retyped by hand	Quick win: Document AI, automate
"Where is my order?" contacts	Quick win: agent with a lookup
Product descriptions	Quick win: augment copywriters
Shopper photo search	Big bet: data and integration first
Credit decisions by Gemini	Drop: wrong tool, as module 9 showed

THE TAKEAWAY

Three quick wins first, one big bet planned, one idea dropped. Start where value and feasibility are both high.

> Wrenfield's chief executive says: "I want AI in every department within a year."
>
> She asks the leadership team what to do first.

What should the team do first?

A Buy enterprise licences for every member of staff

B Identify specific business problems, with measurable outcomes, in each department

C Train a custom model on all company data

D Ask each department to pick an AI product

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do first?

A Buy enterprise licences for every member of staff

Technology first, with no problem defined.

B Identify specific business problems, with measurable outcomes, in each department

Problem first, with a way to prove success.

C Train a custom model on all company data

Huge cost with no defined use.

D Ask each department to pick an AI product

Products first, not problems.

THE TAKEAWAY

Start from the business problem, not the technology.

> Wrenfield is choosing between two ideas.
>
> Idea one: summarise supplier emails for buyers, valuable, with clean data ready. Idea two: an agent that renegotiates supplier contracts on its own, valuable, but with no data, high risk and complex systems.

Which should Wrenfield start with?

A Idea two, because it is more ambitious

B Neither, until both are possible

C Both at once, to save time

D Idea one, a high-value, high-feasibility quick win

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which should Wrenfield start with?

A Idea two, because it is more ambitious

Ambition is not feasibility.

B Neither, until both are possible

Waiting loses the quick win.

C Both at once, to save time

Splits effort; the risky one may sink both.

D Idea one, a high-value, high-feasibility quick win

High value and high feasibility: start here.

THE SIGNAL

High value and high feasibility: the quick win comes first.

> Wrenfield's store managers want quick answers to policy questions on the shop floor.
>
> The company already uses Google Workspace, the handbook is in Drive, and nobody wants a long IT project.

Which solution type fits best?

A Train a custom model on the handbook

B Build a custom app on Agent Platform with the ADK

C Use or configure an existing product, such as Gemini Enterprise or Gemini Notebook

D Hire a data science team first

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which solution type fits best?

A Train a custom model on the handbook

The top rung; slow and costly.

B Build a custom app on Agent Platform with the ADK

Works, but more effort than needed.

C Use or configure an existing product, such as Gemini Enterprise or Gemini Notebook

The lowest rung that meets the need.

D Hire a data science team first

A team before a need for one.

THE SIGNAL

Choose the lowest rung of the ladder that meets the requirements.

> Wrenfield is considering AI for two jobs.
>
> Job one: tagging 1,200 new products a month into 40 categories. Job two: deciding which suppliers to drop after a poor season, which affects jobs and contracts.

How should AI be applied?

A Automate the tagging, and augment the supplier decision

B Automate both

C Augment both, with a person checking every tag

D Use AI for neither

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should AI be applied?

A Automate the tagging, and augment the supplier decision

Routine work automated; high stakes kept with people.

B Automate both

Hands a high-stakes call to the machine.

C Augment both, with a person checking every tag

Wastes people on a routine task.

D Use AI for neither

Misses an easy win.

THE SIGNAL

Repetitive and rule-bound: automate. High stakes and judgement: augment.

> After a three-month pilot, Wrenfield's copywriting assistant gets enthusiastic feedback from writers.
>
> The finance director asks for proof of value, but nobody measured writing time before the pilot began.

What was the main mistake?

A Choosing the wrong model

B Running the pilot for too long

C Not taking a baseline before the pilot

D Using too few writers

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What was the main mistake?

A Choosing the wrong model

The model choice is not the problem.

B Running the pilot for too long

Length does not matter without a baseline.

C Not taking a baseline before the pilot

No baseline, so no proof of change.

D Using too few writers

More writers still give no baseline.

THE TAKEAWAY

No baseline, no proof. Measure before you start.

> Wrenfield's invoice automation is costed at the licence fee alone.
>
> The finance director challenges the return on investment figure.

What is most likely missing from the cost side?

A The model's accuracy score

B Build, integration, change management and upkeep costs

C The number of invoices processed

D Customer satisfaction

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is most likely missing from the cost side?

A The model's accuracy score

A quality measure, not a cost.

B Build, integration, change management and upkeep costs

The full cost of making it work.

C The number of invoices processed

Volume drives benefit, not missing cost.

D Customer satisfaction

A soft benefit, not a cost.

THE SIGNAL

Count all costs, including people and change, not just the licence.

Module 24 in five lines

- Start from the business problem, with a measurable outcome.
- Prioritise by value and feasibility: quick wins first, big bets planned.
- Choose the lowest solution rung that meets the requirements.
- Automate the repetitive and rule-bound; augment the creative and high-stakes.
- Baseline first, count every cost, and decide when the pilot ends.